

JOE PIRES

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ABOUT

I have been a software engineer since graduating from the University of Pennsylvania. I started my career at Amazon, working on Alexa's reminder and alarm features. After Amazon, I worked at FanDuel. At FanDuel, I worked on developing two new products: Cartola FC and Faceoff. Cartola FC brought FanDuel's Daily Fantasy Sports (DFS) ecosystem to Brazil. Faceoff blended the DFS ecosystem with skill-based games. It has been a success, leading to hundreds of thousands of unique users. Throughout my career, I leveraged CI/CD, observability, and infrastructure as code. Before leaving FanDuel, I was working on implementing generosity features for FanDuel's products, including the new Predicts prediction market platform.

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA | *Bachelor's* 2019

- Cumulative GPA: 3.45. *Cum Laude*
- Member - Pi Sigma Alpha
- Related Coursework: Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning

EXPERIENCE

FANDUEL

NEW YORK, NY

Senior Software Engineer

MARCH 2023 – JUNE 2026

- Worked with FanDuel's teams in Europe, as well as Flutter's Cross Product Promotion (CPP) developers to offer greater generosity benefits for FanDuel users, opening up more promotion options for more products.
- Worked on the backend functionality for both the Picks and Predicts products, integrating both products into FanDuel's generosity backend.
- Built Beat The Pros for Faceoff on FanDuel's existing AWS infrastructure, writing and modifying Terraform configs and deploying via Buildkite CI/CD pipelines.
- Leveraged Kafka to migrate FanDuel's notification pipeline from Segment/Braze to High-touch.
- Redesigned FanDuel's ticketing and voucher backend to split read-only and read-write database traffic across separate replica and primary databases, resolving the database load issue behind a prior Super Bowl outage and preventing recurrence during future high-traffic events.
- Continued working with WorldWinner to refine Faceoff and add new features to it, including prohibiting specific games based on the user's location, and crediting bonus Sportsbook bets to Faceoff users.
- Worked on new features to improve the DFS experience for users, one example being more flexible rewarding.

Software Engineer

NOVEMBER 2020 – MARCH 2023

- Worked in partnership with external companies Globo and BtoBet to develop the distributed backend needed for Cartola FC, a sports betting platform for Brazil's Serie A and for the 2022 World Cup.
- Worked with external company WorldWinner to develop the backend for the Faceoff app, which blends FanDuel's DFS platform with WorldWinner's games. Throughout its lifetime, Faceoff brought in hundreds of thousands of users into the FanDuel ecosystem.

- Mentored co-workers, worked on company-wide initiatives to improve things like monitoring, and interviewed prospective software engineers at FanDuel.
- Was heavily involved in Operational Excellence and on-call tasks, whether it was for a special event, or a product release. Worked to improve stability of FanDuel's backend services.

AMAZON

SANTA CLARA, CA

Software Engineer

JULY 2019 – JUNE 2020

- Updated Alexa's reminder service to help users differentiate between various types of reminders.
- Coordinated and drove the effort to refine the scripts used by Alexa for reminders for better translation. This was especially important due to the release of Alexa in Brazil.
- Assisted on occasion in the effort to create the Tell Me When feature.

Software Development Engineering Intern

MAY 2018 – AUGUST 2018

- Worked with the Alexa Alarms team to develop a new feature to send push notifications to a user's phone, allowing them to turn off alarms from their phone rather than directly on the device.

UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA DIGITAL SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM

PHILADELPHIA, PA

Digital Projects Assistant

MAY 2017 – MAY 2019

- Increased functionality in and helped redesign Scalar for use in various courses, including adding automatic PDF conversion, automatic generation of books for journals, and facilitating peer reviews.
- Improved functionality in the Open Richly Annotated Cuneiform Corpus (ORACC), including adding a user registration feature, improving server functionality, and adding features used in the GUI for ORACC. This helped facilitate transliteration of cuneiform tablets.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Proficient Java, Python, Unix, Datadog, Git, SQL

Intermediate AWS, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Spring Boot, C#, Kafka, Terraform, Buildkite

Basic LaTeX, React, Swift, C++, Ruby, C